

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 5 3  
♥ A T 3 2  
♦ J 4  
♣ K T 9

♠ K T 8 2

♥ 7 4

♦ A K 6 3

♣ A J 7



♠ A 4

♥ K J 9 8

♦ T 8 7 2

♣ 8 6 5

♠ Q 9 6

♥ Q 6 5

♦ Q 9 5

♣ Q 4 3 2

West

North  
1NT

East

South

All Pass

1NT by North

North opens 1NT.

If partner has a 4-card ♥ suit to match yours you could revalue your hand and add a point for your doubleton ♠. That would give you the 9 points you need for an invitational response.

It is far too risky to play for that possibility. So you just pass.

**Board 2**

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 7 2  
 ♥ K 5  
 ♦ J 6 4 3  
 ♣ J 4 3 2

♠ A 4

♥ A J 9 8

♦ T 8 7 2

♣ 8 6 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ T 8 6 3

♥ Q 7 4 2

♦ K 5

♣ A 9 7

♠ K Q J 5

♥ T 6 3

♦ A Q 9

♣ K Q T

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2♣    | Pass | 2♠    |
| Pass         | 2NT   | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

South opens 1NT.

You have 9 points and a 4-card Major. Just enough for an invitational Stayman sequence. You bid 2♣ and partner answers 2♠.

Partner has the wrong Major. Now that you know there is no 8-card Major fit you must go to notrump. And since you don't have the strength to insist on game you say 2NT which is an invitation for partner to bid 3NT if he has a maximum.

He has a maximum and he bids 3NT.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 4  
 ♥ Q J T 3  
 ♦ Q 4 3 2  
 ♣ K 5 2

♠ A 9 8 3

♥ A K 5

♦ A 9 5

♣ J 9 4



♠ J 7 2

♥ 8 7 2

♦ 7 6

♣ A Q T 8 6

♠ K Q T 6

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K J T 8

♣ 7 3

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 1NT   | Pass | 2♣    |
| Pass        | 2♠    | Pass | 4♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by North |       |      |       |

North opens 1NT.

Of course you bid 2♣. Partner now bids 2♠. What is your next bid?

Partner hit your suit. When you add a point for your doubleton ♣ you are up to 10 points. This is the situation where you have to use your judgement, either to invite or to bid the game yourself.

There is really no right or wrong here, between 3♠ and 4♠. Those extra 10's and 9's swing you to 4♠. As you see it will be a close call, but even if you misguess the ♦ finesse you will still establish a ♦ winner for a discard.

**Board 4**

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 7 3 2

♥ T 7 2

♦ J 7 2

♣ A 4 3

♠ A J T 4

♥ K Q J 5

♦ 8 6 3

♣ J 7



♠ Q 8

♥ 8 6 4 3

♦ K 9 4

♣ T 9 5 2

♠ 9 6 5

♥ A 9

♦ A Q T 5

♣ K Q 8 6

South opens 1NT.

Both Majors! Lucky you. So you bid a Stayman 2♣.  
Unfortunately partner comes back with 2♦. What is  
your next bid?

Partner doesn't have a 4-card Major so your side  
doesn't have an 8-card Major fit. Therefore you will  
play in notrump. And with your 12 points you  
**MUST** play in game. So you bid 3NT.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2♣    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5  
♥ T 9 7  
♦ J T 6 5 3  
♣ Q J 6

♠ T 9 8 2

♥ K Q 6

♦ A 9 4

♣ A K 5



♠ 7 6 4

♥ 8 4 3 2

♦ K Q 8

♣ T 7 2

♠ K Q J 3

♥ A J 5

♦ 7 2

♣ 9 8 4 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

North opens 1NT.

With 11 points and a 4-card Major suit you bid 2♣.

Partner answers 2♠. What is your next bid?

Stayman bidding can be very straightforward. Partner has 4 ♠s, you have 4 ♠s. That makes 8. Partner has 15-17 points, you have 11-12 points. That makes 26-29.

You bid 4♠.

**Board 6**

South Deals

E-W Vul

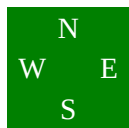
♠ 7 6 2  
 ♥ 3 2  
 ♦ 7 6 3  
 ♣ J T 9 8 7

♠ A T 9 4

♥ K J T 7

♦ A J

♣ K Q 3



♠ J 8 3

♥ A 8 6 4

♦ T 8 5 2

♣ 5 4

♠ K Q 5

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K Q 9 4

♣ A 6 2

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass         | 2♣    | Pass | 2♦    |
| Pass         | 6NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 6NT by South |       |      |       |

South opens 1NT.

You have a very big hand. Enormous. But you also have two 4-card Majors, so the first step is Stayman. You bid 2♣ and partner replies 2♦.

You have 18 points and partner has 15, 16 or 17. Your total is between 33 and 35. You have enough POINTS for a small slam, not enough for a grand. You have no Major suit fit, and are happy to play notrump.

There is a lot to be said for bidding 6NT immediately. You could ask for Aces if you like but whether partner shows one or two isn't going to change your decision. Be bold.